

## WEEKLY MARKETS SUMMARY

## Week of August 31–September 4, 2026

Global Markets Analysis · Nomad Capital · September 2026

WTI CRUDE OIL —  
WEEKLY CHG.**+9.28%**

\$83.44 → \$91.18 · Hormuz escalation

ARGENTINA EMBI —  
WEEKLY CHG.**−18 bps**

Close 9/3: 494 bps · weeks-long low

BITCOIN —  
WEEKLY CHG.**+3.06%**

\$77,341 → \$79,707

S&P Merval (ARS) —  
WEEKLY CHG.**+2.05%**

2,987,913 → 3,049,122 pts

A week of whiplash in U.S. monetary policy, with the Fed speaking in multiple voices just days after Jackson Hole. Governor Waller surprised on Thursday with a markedly more dovish tone than Warsh's, signaling he'd support holding rates steady if disinflation continues — the market celebrated with its best session in a month (Dow +635 points) — but Friday's August jobs report threw cold water on the optimism: nonfarm payrolls surprised with 162,000 jobs created, triple what was expected, reversing much of the rally and pushing the odds of a September rate hike back to 50%. In parallel, the war between the U.S. and Iran kept escalating in the Strait of Hormuz, pushing oil to its biggest weekly gain in more than a month. In Argentina, the week brought additional relief: country risk retreated to a multi-week low and the Merval extended the recovery that began the prior week, as the market starts to read the spread compression as a bet on program continuity beyond October's legislative turnover.

## 1. Timeline of the Week

### WEEKLY TIMELINE

Mon 8/31

The U.S. strikes Iran in the Strait of Hormuz: American forces hit Iranian launchers on Larak Island; Tehran vows retaliation. Trump secures control of 65 billion barrels of Venezuelan oil via a firm with Pentagon involvement. Hawkish comments from Warsh revive bets on a September rate hike. Apple changes CEOs: John Ternus replaces Tim Cook, with AI as the top priority. Canada announces retaliatory tariffs starting September 8. Argentina's EMBI closes the prior Friday at 512 bps.

Tue 9/1

The Hormuz escalation deepens with new cross-strikes between the U.S. and Iran; oil extends its rise and sovereign yields touch multi-year highs globally. Eurozone inflation tops 3% in August, reinforcing bets on an ECB rate hike. Wall Street closes out August lower, dragged down by Warsh's hawkish Jackson Hole speech and the jump in oil. Bessent publicly pressures the Bank of Japan to raise rates. Argentina's EMBI closes at 512 bps, unchanged; the dollar-denominated Merval closed August down 12% and country risk climbed 80 points for the month, the biggest jump since February.

Wed 9/2

Hormuz remains on fire: new exchanges of strikes between the U.S. and Iran. The 10-year Japanese government bond tops 3% for the first time in thirty years, amid a global bond selloff. Warsh publicly admits current monetary policy isn't restrictive, and the market raises the odds of a September hike to 70%. The G20 finance ministers' meeting ends in shouting matches over tariff disputes. Venezuela's National Assembly backs the oil agreement with the U.S. covering 17 fields. In Argentina, stocks rise as much as 7% on Wall Street and country risk nears 500 points, closing at 501 bps (-11 bps).

Thu 9/3

Fed Governor Christopher Waller surprises with a markedly dovish tone: in a public interview, he says that if August's inflation data confirms recent disinflation, he'd support holding rates steady at the September 15-16 meeting — though he clarifies he'd vote to hike if inflation "comes in hot." Markets celebrate: the Dow rises 635 points (+1.18%), its best session in a month, the S&P 500 adds 1.06%, and the Nasdaq gains 1.40%. The 10-year Treasury yield falls to 4.76% from its highest level since November 2023. The odds of a September rate hike drop from 63% to 50%. The yen strengthens 2% on hawkish signals from a Bank of Japan board member. Argentina's EMBI closes at 494 bps (-6 bps), with Argentine globals higher in Buenos Aires.

Fri 9/4

August's U.S. jobs report surprises with 162,000 positions created, triple the 53,000 consensus and reversing July's weak reading (revised up from -23,000 to +21,000). Unemployment holds at 4.1%. The market interprets the data as a sign the Fed has more room to raise rates, and much of Thursday's rally reverses: the Dow falls roughly 300 points, the S&P 500 retreats 0.5%, and short-end yields rise. Oil is on track for its biggest weekly gain in more than a month amid the Hormuz escalation. Nvidia consolidates its dominant AI position with its bid for Hugging Face. Milei relaunches the Falklands/Malvinas claim with new sanctions on unauthorized oil exploration.

## 2. Weekly Asset Price Changes

Prior close: Friday 8/28. Reference close: Friday 9/4.

| Asset                   | Close Fri 8/28 | Close Fri 9/4 | Weekly chg. |
|-------------------------|----------------|---------------|-------------|
| S&P 500                 | 7,711.76       | 7,718.60      | +0.09%      |
| Nasdaq 100              | 29,433.43      | 29,544.15     | +0.38%      |
| Dow Jones               | 53,559.99      | 53,414.25     | -0.27%      |
| VIX                     | 14.43          | 14.53         | +0.69%      |
| 10-Yr UST               | 4.72%          | 4.78%         | +6 bps      |
| WTI (spot)              | \$83.44        | \$91.18       | +9.28%      |
| Gold (spot)             | \$4,504.10     | \$4,476.00    | -0.62%      |
| Bitcoin                 | \$77,341.15    | \$79,707.05   | +3.06%      |
| EMBI Global (Argentina) | 512 bps        | 494 bps*      | -18 bps     |

| Argentina local market | Close Fri 8/28 | Close Fri 9/4 | Weekly chg. |
|------------------------|----------------|---------------|-------------|
| GD30D                  | \$0.5780       | \$0.5810      | +0.52%      |
| GD35D                  | \$0.7986       | \$0.8011      | +0.31%      |
| S&P Merval (ARS)       | 2,987,913.25   | 3,049,121.50  | +2.05%      |
| S&P Merval (USD MEP)   | 1,943.37       | 1,998.44      | +2.83%      |
| USD MEP (AL30)         | \$1,537.49     | \$1,525.75    | -0.76%      |

\* Argentina's EMBI reflects the last confirmed official close (Thursday 9/3); JP Morgan publishes with a lag. GD30D, GD35D, and MEP verified on Balanz Productores at Friday 9/4's close. U.S. prices correspond to Friday 9/4's close, already reflecting the full market reaction to the August jobs report.

## 3. Key Drivers of the Week

### KEY DRIVERS

#### Waller surprises with a dovish pivot that Wall Street celebrates with its best session in a month

In a public interview on Thursday, the Fed governor said he'd support holding rates steady at the September meeting if August's inflation data confirms recent disinflation — though he clarified he'd vote for a hike if inflation "comes in hot." The contrast with Warsh's tone at Jackson Hole, barely a week earlier, was notable: while Warsh warned the Fed "has more work to do," Waller suggested current policy is already sufficiently restrictive. The market read the signal as a partial green light: the Dow rose 635 points, its best session in a month, and the odds of a rate hike fell from 63% to 50%. The episode confirms the Fed arrives at the September meeting genuinely divided, with the committee communicating in different directions depending on who's speaking.

#### The jobs report reverses much of the rally and reintroduces uncertainty

The creation of 162,000 jobs in August — triple the consensus — is exactly the kind of surprise that, in the current context, works against risk assets: with the Fed looking for signs the economy can tolerate higher rates without breaking, a strong jobs number reduces the room to sustain the dovish tone Waller had hinted at just 24 hours earlier. The reaction was immediate: much of Thursday's gain reversed, and the odds of a rate hike rose again. The underlying read is that the market no longer operates under the traditional pattern of "weak data is good for stocks": now a strong jobs report reopens fears of a more aggressive Fed, inverting the logic that dominated much of the past two years.

#### Oil posts its best week in more than a month on the Hormuz escalation

WTI rose 9.28% for the week, topping \$91 a barrel, after a fresh U.S. strike on Iranian launchers on Larak Island and successive exchanges of fire in the Strait of Hormuz throughout the week. The escalation compounds with Washington's agreement to control 65 billion barrels of Venezuelan oil, in a week where energy geopolitics took center stage. U.S. diesel touched its highest level since April, a transmission channel into core inflation that Fed models tend to underweight in the short term, given its direct effect on freight costs.

#### Argentina extends the relief: country risk touches a multi-week low

Argentina's EMBI closed the week at 494 bps, its lowest level since before August's escalation, with the Merval adding 2.05% in pesos and 2.83% in MEP dollars. The market read, circulating among analysts, is that funds have started pricing in continuity of the economic program beyond October's legislative turnover, betting that the ruling coalition retains governability despite the wear from its confrontational style. The variable to watch isn't so much the level of country risk but the speed of its compression relative to political volatility, which remains high ahead of the elections.

#### 4. Signals to Watch — Week of September 7–11

##### SIGNALS TO WATCH

###### U.S. August inflation data (CPI and PPI)

Waller explicitly conditioned his support for holding rates on these data confirming recent disinflation. They're the decisive input ahead of the September 15-16 meeting, and their outcome will determine whether this week's episode was the start of a more dovish consensus or just a parenthesis within a divided Fed.

###### Evolution of the Iran-U.S. escalation in the Strait of Hormuz

With cross-strikes throughout the week and no signs of an agreement nearby, the central question remains whether the conflict settles into a new low-intensity equilibrium or keeps escalating, with oil as the main market thermometer.

###### Sustainability of Argentina's country-risk compression

With the EMBI at a multi-week low, the market will start testing whether that compression reflects genuine conviction about program continuity or is vulnerable to any negative surprise ahead of October's legislative turnover.

###### Yen's reaction to hawkish signals from the Bank of Japan

After strengthening 2% during the week on comments from a board member, the market will watch closely whether the BOJ actually moves toward a concrete rate hike or whether the verbal signals once again fail to translate into action, as happened weeks ago.

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